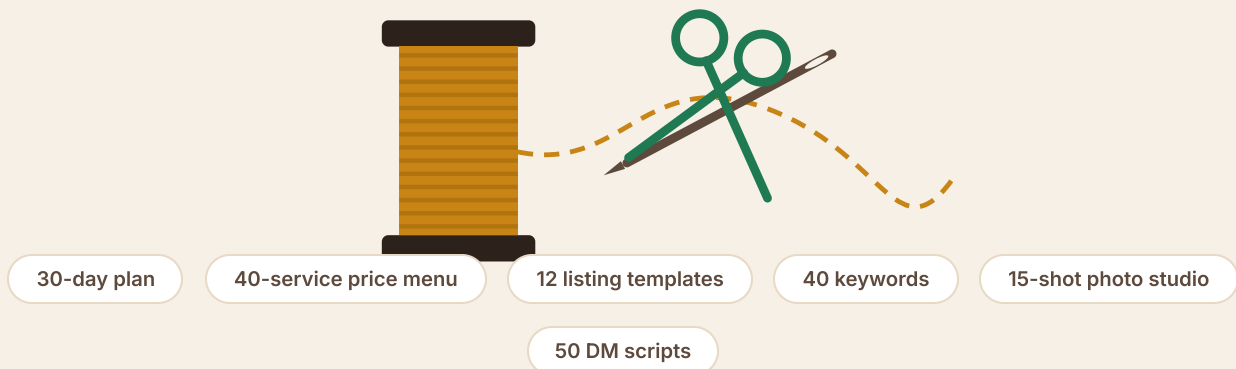


SEWING **AT** HOME

OTO 1 · SIDE INCOME

The Sew & Sell **Side-Income** Blueprint™

The exact 30-day plan to turn your sewing machine into your first \$1,000 in orders — alterations, custom pieces and quick-sell items, without paid ads.



Inside this blueprint

Read Part 1 once from start to finish, then work one day at a time. Parts 2–5 are your toolbox: you come back to them every day of the plan.

1 The 30-Day Sew & Sell Blueprint

The \$1,000 math, the \$114 startup list and 30 days of tasks with time and result for each.

2 The Alterations Price Menu

Pricing logic + 40 services with US price ranges, time and \$/hour check.

3 12 Listing Templates + 40 Keywords

Etsy and Facebook Marketplace titles, descriptions and 13 tags each.

4 The Phone Photo Studio

The \$8 setup and 15 shots with exact setup and phone settings.

5 50 DM & Comment Scripts

Inquiries, price objections, custom orders, follow-ups, reviews and referrals.

+ Printables (separate PDFs)

Client-facing Alterations Price Menu (filled + blank) · 30-Day Tracker · Job Log · Pricing Worksheet.

BEFORE YOU START

You need: a domestic sewing machine that sews straight and zigzag, an iron, and the patterns in your Sewing Pattern Bible (the Creative Sewing Projects folder has the pouch, tote, apron, scrunchie and bandana patterns used in Part 3). Measurements in this guide are given in cm and inches; seam allowance is 1.5 cm / 5/8 in unless stated.

A NOTE ON MONEY AND TAXES

Income from sewing is taxable. In the US, self-employment tax applies once you earn \$400+ net in a year; keep every receipt and set aside ~25% of profit. Check your city's rules for home businesses. This guide is practical business advice, not legal or tax advice.

PART 1

The 30-Day Sew & Sell Blueprint

Day by day, from zero clients to your first \$1,000 in orders — with alterations (fast cash), one quick-sell product line and two custom pieces. No paid ads. About 60–90 minutes a day plus the sewing itself.

This plan is built on real numbers, not on hope. Here is exactly what adds up to \$1,000: mostly alterations, because everybody already owns clothes that don't fit, plus a small stock of pouches and totes and two custom pieces that show what you can make.

The \$1,000 math

INCOME LINE	PRICE	WK 1	WK 2	WK 3	WK 4	UNITS	TOTAL
Alterations (average ticket)	\$22	3	8	8	7	26	\$572
Lined zipper pouch 9 × 6 in / 23 × 15 cm	\$18	3	4	2	1	10	\$180
Lined canvas tote bag	\$32	—	1	2	1	4	\$128
Custom elastic-waist linen skirt (made to measure)	\$95	—	—	1	—	1	\$95
Custom kids' twirl dress (size 2–10)	\$58	—	—	—	1	1	\$58
Week total		\$120	\$280	\$371	\$262		
Running total		\$120	\$400	\$771	\$1,033		\$1,033

26

alteration jobs · avg \$22

14

quick-sell products

2

custom pieces with 50% deposit

WHAT "ORDERS" MEANS HERE

\$1,033 is the value of the orders you take in 30 days. Your materials for the whole month cost about \$114 (list below) and last beyond day 30 — thread, needles and tools serve dozens more jobs. The sewing time is roughly 45–55 hours across the month, which is why the plan leans on alterations: they pay \$25–35 an hour from day one.

Startup list (Day 2 • budget \$114)

WHAT TO BUY	APPROX. US COST
Seam ripper, tailor's chalk, 6 in / 15 cm sewing gauge, glass-head pins	\$18
Needles: universal 80/12 (5-pack), denim 100/16 (5-pack), jersey 75/11 (5-pack)	\$14

WHAT TO BUY	APPROX. US COST
All-purpose polyester thread: black, navy, white, grey, beige + gold jeans topstitch thread	\$16
Pouch stock: 1.5 yd / 1.4 m quilting cotton outer + 1 yd / 0.9 m lining + 1 yd fusible woven interfacing	\$30
10 nylon zippers 9 in / 23 cm	\$8
Tote stock: 2 yd / 1.8 m 10 oz canvas + 1 yd lining	\$28
Total	\$114

CHANNELS USED IN THIS PLAN (ALL FREE)

- **Your warm list** — 40 people who already know you. Most first jobs come from here.
- **Local Facebook groups + Nextdoor** — alterations are a local service; that's where neighbors ask "does anyone know a seamstress?".
- **Facebook Marketplace** — pouches, totes and kids' pieces for local pickup or shipping. No listing fees for local pickup.
- **Etsy** — \$0.20 per listing; brings strangers from all over the US from week 3 on.
- **1-2 referral partners** — dry cleaners, bridal or formal boutiques, uniform stores that don't sew in-house.

Week 1 • Open for business (Days 1–7)

You set your prices, stock one quick-sell product and tell the people who already know you. Alterations are the fastest money in sewing: nobody needs to trust your taste, only your hem. Target for the week: **3 alteration jobs + 3 pouches = \$120.**

DAY
1

☐ Set your hourly rate and circle your launch menu

Read Part 2 (Pricing Logic). Write your target rate on a sticky note: **\$30/hour** if you are a confident beginner, \$35–40 if you have sewn for years. Print the Alterations Price Menu (printables file) and circle the 20 services you can already do well: hems, straps, sleeves without cuffs, buttons, seam repairs. Those 20 are your launch menu. The rest you add as you practice.

⌚ 45 min

Result: A launch menu of 20 services with prices you can defend.

DAY
2

☐ Kit check + one supply run (budget \$114)

Buy only what is on the Startup List on the next page. Wash and press the pouch and tote fabrics today so they are ready tomorrow. Put a basket by the door labelled *IN* (client drop-offs) and one labelled *DONE* (ready for pickup).

⌚ 90 min

Result: Everything you need for 26 alterations, 10 pouches and 4 totes.

DAY
3

☐ Batch-sew 3 zipper pouches

Pouch: cut 2 outer + 2 lining at 10 × 7 in / 25.5 × 18 cm, interface the outer. Zipper sandwich, then sew outer-to-outer and lining-to-lining with a 3/8 in / 1 cm seam, leave a 3 in / 7.5 cm turning gap in the lining, box the corners at 1 in / 2.5 cm, turn, edge-stitch the gap. Cut all 3 first, then do each step on all 3: batching cuts the time from ~35 to ~20 min each.

⌚ 75 min

Result: 3 finished pouches = your first stock and your photo samples.

DAY
4

☐ Set up your Phone Photo Studio and shoot

Follow Part 4. Shoot shots 1–7 on the pouches. Then take a pair of your own pants, pin the hem up 1 in / 2.5 cm and shoot shot 13 (before/after) — it becomes the photo for your alterations post.

⌚ 90 min

Result: 10–12 clean photos: enough for every post this week.

DAY
5

☐ Tell your warm list (no public ad yet)

Write a list of 40 real people: neighbors, coworkers, school parents, church or gym friends, family. Post Script #1 (launch post) on your personal Facebook with the before/after photo and a photo of the printed menu. Then send Script #2 privately to your 15 closest contacts — one by one, never as a group message.

⌚ 60 min

Result: 5–10 replies. Usually 2–3 people have a pair of pants waiting for a hem.

DAY
6

☐ Post in 3 local groups + list the pouches

Join 3 local Facebook groups (your town's community group, a buy/sell/trade group, a local moms' group) and read the self-promotion rules. Post Script #3. List the 3 pouches on Facebook Marketplace using Listing Template #1 at \$18 each (local pickup + shipping).

⌚ 60 min

Result: 3 live listings and the first strangers asking "how much for a hem?".

DAY
7

☐ Do the first jobs perfectly + weekly check

Every job gets: measured and pinned on the client (or on a garment that fits her), pressed before and after, a thread-clipped inside, and returned on a hanger with a thank-you note. Fill in Week 1 of the 30-Day Tracker.

🕒 2–3 h

Result: 3 jobs done, 3 pouches sold: \$120. Three people who will talk about you.

Week 2 • Build local demand (Days 8–14)

Local word of mouth is slow on its own, so you give it three pushes: a set drop-off routine, businesses that send you overflow, and an Etsy shop that works while you sleep. Target for the week: **8 alterations + 4 pouches + 1 tote = \$280** (running total \$400).

DAY
8

☐ Fix your drop-off windows

Pick two fixed windows, e.g. **Tuesday 5–7 pm** and **Saturday 9–11 am**. Clients drop off and pick up only then. Standard turnaround: 5 days. Rush (48 h): +50%. Put the windows in every post and reply from now on.

🕒 20 min

Result: Clients stop showing up at dinner time, and your week becomes plannable.

DAY
9

☐ Batch 4 pouches + 2 totes

Tote: cut 2 outer 17 × 18 in / 43 × 46 cm in 10 oz canvas, 2 lining, 2 straps 4 × 25 in / 10 × 63.5 cm folded to 1 in / 2.5 cm. Denim 100/16 needle, stitch length 3 mm, box corners 2 in / 5 cm, reinforce strap ends with a box-X. Pouch recipe as Day 3.

🕒 3 h

Result: Stock for the week: 4 pouches, 2 totes.

DAY
10

☐ Open your Etsy shop with 3 listings

Shop name: 2–3 words, easy to spell. Publish Listing Templates #1 (pouch), #2 (tote) and #11 (made-to-measure linen skirt). Each listing costs \$0.20 to publish. Processing: “ships in 1–2 days” for stock, “made to order in 7–10 business days” for the skirt.

🕒 2 h

Result: Shop live. Etsy needs 3–10 days to index new listings, so it pays off in Week 3.

DAY
11

☐ Pitch 2 local businesses for overflow

Walk into 2 businesses that sell clothes but have no in-house tailor: a dry cleaner that sends out, a formal-wear or bridal boutique, a school-uniform store, a consignment shop. Bring the printed menu and one finished hem. Use Script #41 (in person). Offer them 10% of every job they send, or a free hem for the owner.

🕒 90 min

Result: At least 1 referral partner. One partner can send 5–15 jobs a month.

DAY
12

☐ Before/after post #2 + answer every comment

Post a new before/after (a real client job, with her permission, no face). Reply to every comment within 2 hours with Scripts #1–#10. Any “so pretty!” gets a like + Script #6.

🕒 45 min

Result: 3–5 new jobs booked into your Saturday window.

DAY

13

☐ **Launch your first custom offer**

Post one custom item: the made-to-measure elastic-waist linen skirt at \$95 (materials ~\$22: 2 yd / 1.8 m linen + 1.25 in / 3 cm elastic). Take a 50% deposit to start and use the Custom Order Form approach from Part 5 (Scripts #21–#30).

⌚ 45 min

Result: 1 skirt order with deposit. It shows people you can make, not only fix.

DAY

14

☐ **Weekly review**

Count jobs, pouches, totes and money on the Tracker. Which post brought most messages? Do more of that one. Which service took longer than the menu says? Raise its price by \$5 next week.

⌚ 30 min

Result: Running total \$400.

Week 3 • Get seen by strangers (Days 15–21)

Happy clients are now your proof. This week you put them to work: reviews, a Saturday hem drive, and listings that show up in search. Target for the week: **8 alterations + 2 pouches + 2 totes + 1 custom skirt = \$371** (running total \$771).

DAY

15

☐ **Ask every client for a review**

Send Scripts #46–#48 to everyone you have sewn for. Ask for a Google review (if you created a free Business Profile) or a recommendation post in the local group. Screenshot every kind message (with permission) into a phone album called *PROOF*.

⌚ 30 min

Result: 5+ reviews/recommendations that you reuse in every future post.

DAY

16

☐ **Etsy tune-up**

Stats → Views per listing. Any listing under 20 views: new first photo (shot 1 or 8) and a title that starts with a keyword from the 40-keyword list. Fill all 13 tags on every listing.

⌚ 45 min

Result: Listings that start to show up for buyers who don't know you.

DAY

17

☐ **Announce a “Hem Drive Saturday”**

Post: “This Saturday only, 9–11 am: bring up to 3 pairs of pants, basic hems \$15 each (normally \$18–20). Ready Wednesday.” Share it in the 3 groups and with your warm list.

⌚ 30 min

Result: 4–8 hems in one morning. The volume that makes the month.

DAY

18

☐ **Sew the custom skirt and film it**

Sew the Day 13 skirt. Film 5 clips of 3 seconds each (shot 14) while you work — cutting, serging, elastic, hem, reveal. Post the 15-second video with “made-to-measure, waist to hem in 7 days”.

⌚ 3–4 h

Result: Skirt delivered (\$95) and a video that sells the next custom order.

DAY
19

☐ Batch 2 pouches + 1 tote, relist sold items

Use the Etsy “renew sold” option so the listing keeps its history. Replace sold Marketplace listings with fresh photos (Marketplace favors new listings).

⌚ 2 h

Result: Fresh stock and fresh listings.

DAY
20

☐ Follow up the “maybe” people

Everyone who asked a price but never booked gets Script #31 or #32. Never more than 2 follow-ups per person.

⌚ 30 min

Result: 1–3 extra jobs from people who were only waiting for a nudge.

DAY
21

☐ Weekly review

Running total should be around **\$771**. Look at your time: if alterations take more than 60% of your hours, raise the three most requested services by \$3–5.

⌚ 30 min

Result: A clear view of which work pays best per hour.

Week 4 • Raise your prices and systemize (Days 22–30)

By now demand is steady. This week you make it easier to repeat: bundles, a kids' custom piece, a partner rhythm and a plan for month 2. Target for the week: **7 alterations + 1 pouch + 1 tote + 1 kids' dress = \$262** (running total \$1,033).

DAY
22

☐ Offer a bundle

“3 basic hems for \$50” or “hem + take-in waist \$45”. Bundles raise the average ticket from ~\$22 toward \$30 without raising any single price.

⌚ 20 min

Result: Higher ticket on every new drop-off.

DAY
23

☐ Post a kids' custom offer

Twirl dress in size 2–10: \$46 for a size 2 up to \$68 for a size 10; the plan counts one at \$58 (a size 6–7, materials ~\$17: 1.5–1.8 yd / 1.4–1.6 m quilting cotton). Kids' custom pieces sell fast to grandmothers and to moms before birthdays and holidays.

⌚ 30 min

Result: 1 kids' order with 50% deposit.

DAY
24

☐ Check in with your referral partner

Bring the partner a small thank-you (a pouch) and 20 printed mini-menus for their counter. Ask: “What do your customers ask for most that you send away?”

⌚ 45 min

Result: More overflow work, and a new service idea.

DAY
25

☐ Sew the kids' dress + photo shoot

Sew and photograph the dress (shots 1, 8, 9, 12). Ask the mom for one photo of the child wearing it (back view is fine).

⌚ 3 h

Result: Dress delivered (\$58) and your best photo of the month.

DAY

26

☐ **Write your policies once**

One note on your phone: drop-off windows, 5-day turnaround, rush +50%, 50% deposit on custom work, unclaimed items after 30 days are donated, no refunds on altered garments (free re-adjustment within 7 days).

⌚ 30 min

Result: Copy-paste answers to 80% of questions.

DAY

27

☐ **Last stock batch + relist**

Batch the last pouch and tote. Relist anything that sold. Do not overstock: 3–4 items per product is enough at this stage.

⌚ 2 h

Result: Stock that matches real demand.

DAY

28

☐ **Ask for referrals**

Every client this week gets Script #49 and a referral card (OTO3 printables if you have them, or a handwritten card): \$5 off her next job for every friend who books.

⌚ 20 min

Result: Your next month starts with clients you didn't have to find.

DAY

29

☐ **Price review**

Any service booked 4+ times this month: raise it \$3–5. Any service that took 30% longer than the menu: raise it too. Any product that didn't sell in 3 weeks: new photos or drop it.

⌚ 30 min

Result: A price list that matches your real time.

DAY

30

☐ **Count, pay yourself, plan month 2**

Fill the final Tracker row. Pay yourself first (set aside 25% for taxes if you are in the US and earning more than \$400 net a year from self-employment). Month 2 goal: same routine + 1 new service + 1 new product. Target: \$1,500.

⌚ 45 min

Result: \$1,033 in orders and a routine you can repeat.

The Alterations Price Menu

40 services with real US price ranges and time estimates, the pricing logic behind them, and when to raise them. A client-facing printable version (filled in and blank) is in the printables folder.

These ranges reflect what independent home seamstresses and small alteration shops in the US typically charge in 2026. Big cities and bridal work sit at the top of the range; small towns and simple jobs at the bottom. Start in the middle.

THE FORMULA

Price = (minutes ÷ 60 × your hourly rate) + materials + a complexity add-on, then round up to the next \$5 (or to the next \$1 under \$20). Example — jeans hem keeping the original hem: 35 min ÷ 60 × \$35 = \$20.42 + \$0 materials + \$5 add-on (denim, heavy seams) = \$25.42 → **\$26**, which sits inside the \$22–30 range.

YOUR HOURLY RATE

Beginner who sews confidently: **\$30/h**. Experienced: \$35–40/h. Bridal and formal: \$45–60/h. Never price from what a big-box store charges for a new pair of pants: clients pay for the fit, not the fabric.

MINIMUM TICKET

Set a minimum of **\$12** per drop-off. A single button costs you the same 10 minutes of talking, pinning and paperwork as a hem; the minimum covers it. Small jobs (patches, buttons, straps) are priced per item on top of that.

COMPLEXITY ADD-ONS

Lined garment +\$10 · each extra layer +\$10–15 · silk, chiffon, sequins, beading or leather +25–50% · topstitched denim +\$5 · client-supplied zipper that fails: you replace it at cost.

RUSH FEE

Standard turnaround 5 days. **48-hour rush: +50%**. Same day: +100% or say no. Rush work is the best-paid hour in your week, and the fee keeps it rare.

FITTINGS

Hems and simple take-ins: 1 fitting (pin at drop-off). Formal and bridal: 2 fittings included; each extra fitting \$15. Always pin with the client wearing the shoes she will use.

WHEN TO QUOTE A RANGE, NOT A PRICE

Quote the range from the menu until you have seen the garment. Give the exact price at drop-off, write it on the ticket, and don't change it afterwards unless you call first.

WHEN TO RAISE PRICES

A service booked 4+ times a month, a waiting list longer than 7 days, or a job that always takes 30% longer than the menu says: raise it by \$3–5. Announce price changes 2 weeks ahead in your post and keep old prices for garments already dropped off.

The 40-service menu

Time = hands-on minutes for a confident home sewist with a domestic machine (pinning, sewing, pressing). "\$/hour at mid price" checks that each service pays at least \$30/h at the middle of its range.

#	SERVICE	US PRICE	TIME	\$/HOUR AT MID PRICE	NOTES
Pants & jeans					
1	Basic hem, casual or dress pants (machine blind hem)	\$15–20	25 min	\$42/h	Most requested job. Launch service.
2	Jeans hem, standard topstitched (gold thread)	\$18–25	30 min	\$43/h	Denim 100/16 needle, stitch length 3–3.5 mm.
3	Jeans hem keeping the original hem ("euro hem")	\$22–30	35 min	\$45/h	Keeps the factory wash line. Charge more; clients love it.
4	Hand-stitched hem, tailored trousers	\$20–28	40 min	\$36/h	Invisible catch-stitch. Wool and suiting.
5	Cuffed trouser hem (create or adjust cuffs)	\$25–35	45 min	\$40/h	Cuff depth usually 1 1/2 in / 4 cm.
6	Taper legs (both legs, knee to hem)	\$25–40	50 min	\$39/h	+\$10 if the outseam has topstitching.
7	Take in or let out waist at center back	\$20–35	40 min	\$41/h	Jeans with a yoke and belt loops: top of the range.
8	Replace pants fly zipper	\$20–30	45 min	\$33/h	Zipper included; metal jeans zipper +\$3.
9	Cut off and hem into shorts	\$18–25	30 min	\$43/h	Ask the exact inseam; mark both legs from the crotch.
10	Knee / thigh patch repair (inside patch + stitching)	\$12–20	20 min	\$48/h	Per patch.
Skirts & dresses					
11	Skirt hem, unlined	\$18–25	30 min	\$43/h	
12	Skirt hem, lined (shell + lining)	\$25–35	45 min	\$40/h	Lining ends 1 in / 2.5 cm above the shell hem.
13	Dress hem, unlined	\$22–35	40 min	\$43/h	Circle or bias skirts: top of the range (let hang 24 h first).
14	Dress hem, lined or 2–3 layers	\$35–60	75 min	\$38/h	Price per layer: +\$10–15.
15	Take in dress at side seams	\$30–50	60 min	\$40/h	With zipper in the side seam: +\$10.
16	Shorten shoulder straps	\$12–18	15 min	\$60/h	Pair.
17	Replace invisible zipper	\$30–45	60 min	\$38/h	Lined dress: top of the range.
18	Add bra-strap keepers or sew in bra cups	\$10–15	15 min	\$50/h	
Tops & shirts					
19	Shorten sleeves, no cuff	\$15–20	25 min	\$42/h	Knit tops: twin needle or coverstitch finish.
20	Shorten sleeves with cuffs (remove and reset cuffs)	\$25–35	50 min	\$36/h	Dress shirts. Keep the placket length.

#	SERVICE	US PRICE	TIME	\$/HOUR AT MID PRICE	NOTES
21	Take in shirt at side seams	\$20–30	40 min	\$38/h	Flat-felled seams: +\$10.
22	Add back darts to a shirt	\$20–30	40 min	\$38/h	Two darts, usually 1/2–3/4 in / 1.3–2 cm each.
23	Shorten top or shirt hem	\$15–22	25 min	\$44/h	Curved shirttail hem: top of the range.
24	Replace buttons (up to 8, buttons supplied by client)	\$8–15	20 min	\$34/h	Buttons supplied by you: + cost.
Jackets & coats					
25	Shorten jacket sleeves, plain or non-working vent	\$30–45	60 min	\$38/h	From the hem, lining re-attached.
26	Shorten jacket sleeves with working buttonholes	\$55–80	90 min	\$45/h	Shorten from the shoulder: quote in person.
27	Replace separating jacket zipper	\$35–55	75 min	\$36/h	Zipper included. Parkas with storm flap: top of the range.
28	Take in jacket at side / back seams	\$40–65	90 min	\$35/h	Includes lining.
29	Replace torn inside pocket bag	\$15–25	30 min	\$40/h	Per pocket.
30	Coat hem, lined	\$40–60	75 min	\$40/h	Wool coats: steam and hand-finish.
Formal & bridal					
31	Bridesmaid / prom dress hem (1–3 layers, chiffon)	\$45–75	90 min	\$40/h	Rolled hem on chiffon; measure with her shoes on.
32	Bridal gown bustle (3–5 points)	\$60–150	120 min	\$52/h	Price per point: \$15–30. Book 3–6 weeks before the wedding.
33	Prom / formal dress take-in + hem	\$75–125	150 min	\$40/h	Two fittings included.
34	Add straps to a strapless dress	\$35–50	60 min	\$42/h	Straps made from matching fabric or ribbon.
35	Bridal gown hem, multiple layers	\$150–300	240 min	\$56/h	Quote after the first fitting. Lace hem: top of the range.
Repairs & home					
36	Fix a split seam or small tear	\$8–15	15 min	\$46/h	Per area. Easiest job on the menu.
37	Sew on a patch or badge (scouts, team, uniform)	\$5–10	10 min	\$45/h	Per patch; 5+ patches: \$5 each.
38	Hem curtains (per panel)	\$15–25	30 min	\$40/h	Lined or blackout: +\$10 per panel.
39	New zippered cushion cover (client's fabric)	\$20–35	40 min	\$41/h	Up to 20 × 20 in / 50 × 50 cm.
40	Kids' clothes: let down or take up a hem	\$10–15	20 min	\$38/h	Growth hems for school uniforms: very popular in August.

THE 20-SERVICE LAUNCH MENU (CIRCLE THESE ON DAY 1)

#1 basic hem · #2 jeans hem · #3 euro hem · #9 into shorts · #10 patch repair · #11 skirt hem · #13 dress hem · #16 straps · #18 bra keepers · #19 sleeves no cuff · #21 take in shirt · #23 shirt hem · #24 buttons · #29 pocket bag · #36 seam repair · #37 patches · #38 curtains · #39 cushion cover · #40 kids' hems · #7 waist at center back.

Add zippers (#8, #17, #27), lined work and formal pieces once you have done each one twice on your own clothes or thrift-store practice pieces.

DROP-OFF TICKET (WRITE THIS FOR EVERY GARMENT)

Client name · garment + color · service # from the menu · measurement or pin mark (e.g. "hem -1 1/4 in / -3 cm, shoes: flats") · price quoted · ready date · paid Y/N. Pin a copy to the garment and keep one in your notebook. The printable Job Log does this for you.

12 Etsy & Marketplace Listing Templates + 40 Keywords

Copy, paste, change the color and measurements to yours. Every template has an Etsy title (under 140 characters), a short Marketplace title, a description and 13 Etsy tags (each under 20 characters).

ETSY RULES THAT MATTER

- Title: put the 2–3 words buyers type first. Etsy reads the start of the title most.
- Use all **13 tags**; each tag max 20 characters; phrases beat single words.
- Fill every attribute (color, material, occasion). They work as extra free tags.
- 10 photos per listing when you can; photo 1 decides the click.
- Listing fee \$0.20 for 4 months; transaction fee 6.5% + payment processing ~3% + \$0.25.

MARKETPLACE RULES THAT MATTER

- Short, plain title: what it is + one detail (size or feature).
- First photo on a clean background; the feed is busy.
- Same price as Etsy — never cheaper.
- Renew or relist every 7 days: fresh listings get shown more.
- Local pickup in a public place or porch pickup; shipping only with a tracking number.

PRICE CHECK BEFORE YOU PUBLISH

Materials × 1 + (sewing minutes ÷ 60 × \$20–25) + \$3 packaging and fees, rounded up to the next \$2.

Example — pouch: \$3.20 + (20 ÷ 60 × \$25 = \$8.33) + \$3 = \$14.53 → \$15 minimum; \$18 leaves room for Etsy fees and a free-shipping sale later. Products pay less per hour than alterations; that is why they are your side line, not your main line, in month one.

#1 • Lined Zipper Pouch

\$18

Materials ≈ \$3.20

⌚ 20 min (batched)

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 11

ETSY TITLE

Handmade Zipper Pouch, Lined Cotton Makeup Bag, 9 × 6 in Pencil Case, Small Gift for Her, Teacher Gift, Travel Organizer Pouch

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Lined Zipper Pouch — 9 × 6 in — Makeup / Pencil Bag

DESCRIPTION

A handmade zipper pouch for everything that rattles around the bottom of your bag: makeup, pens, chargers, snacks.

- Size: 9 × 6 in / 23 × 15 cm, boxed corners so it stands up
- Outer: 100% cotton, interfaced so it holds its shape
- Lined in coordinating cotton, nylon zipper with pull tab
- Machine wash cold, lay flat to dry

Sewn by me in my home studio. Every seam is finished inside, no loose threads. Ready to ship in 1–2 business days. Want 3 or more as teacher or bridesmaid gifts? Send me a message and I'll put a set together.

13 TAGS

zipper pouch

makeup bag

pencil case

cotton pouch

gift for her

teacher gift

travel organizer

cosmetic bag

handmade pouch

stocking stuffer

bridesmaid gift

small gift bag

fabric pouch

#2 • Lined Canvas Tote Bag

\$32

Materials ≈ \$7.50

⌚ 45 min

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 2, 4, 6, 8, 9

ETSY TITLE

Canvas Tote Bag with Inside Pocket, Handmade Lined Tote, Market Bag, Library Bag, Everyday Shoulder Bag, Gift for Mom

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Lined Canvas Tote Bag with Pocket — Sturdy Market Bag

DESCRIPTION

A sturdy everyday tote that actually holds its shape.

- Size: about 14 × 15 in / 35 × 38 cm with a 4 in / 10 cm boxed base
- 10 oz cotton canvas outer, cotton lining, inside slip pocket for keys and phone
- Straps 25 in / 63.5 cm long, reinforced with box-X stitching — fits over your shoulder with a coat on
- Carries up to 20 lb / 9 kg of groceries or books

Machine wash cold, hang to dry, press on medium heat. Ready to ship in 1–2 business days.

13 TAGS

canvas tote bag

tote bag

market bag

library bag

lined tote

shoulder bag

gift for mom

reusable bag

book bag

tote with pocket

handmade tote

grocery bag

everyday bag

#3 • Cross-Back Linen Apron

\$42

Materials ≈ \$11

⌚ 60 min

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 2, 7, 9, 10, 11, 12

ETSY TITLE

Linen Cross Back Apron with Pockets, Japanese Style Apron, No Tie Kitchen Apron, Gardening Apron, Housewarming Gift

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Linen Cross-Back Apron — No Ties, 2 Pockets

DESCRIPTION

No ties, no neck strain: the straps cross in the back and slip over your head.

- One size fits US 4–18 (fits most, ties-free)
- Length from top edge to hem: 33 in / 84 cm
- Two deep front pockets 7 × 8 in / 18 × 20 cm
- Midweight linen-cotton blend, softens with every wash

Perfect for cooking, baking, gardening, pottery and painting. Machine wash warm. Made to order in 3–5 business days in your choice of 4 colors (see photo 6).

13 TAGS

linen apron

cross back apron

japanese apron

kitchen apron

apron with pockets

gardening apron

housewarming gift

baking apron

pottery apron

no tie apron

gift for baker

chef apron

womens apron

#4 • Kids' Pillowcase Dress (sizes 2–10)

\$38

Materials ≈ \$7

⌚ 45 min

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 7, 9, 10, 12

ETSY TITLE

Girls Pillowcase Dress, Toddler Cotton Sundress, Sizes 2 to 10, Handmade Summer Dress, Birthday Outfit, Custom Kids Dress

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Girls Pillowcase Dress — Sizes 2–10 — Made to Order

DESCRIPTION

A classic pillowcase dress in soft quilting cotton with a contrast band and ribbon ties at the shoulders.

- Sizes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10 (US). Choose the size in the drop-down; see the size chart in the photos.
- Adjustable ribbon ties: the same dress fits for 1–2 seasons as she grows
- All seams finished inside, soft on the skin
- Machine wash cold, tumble dry low

Made to order in 3–5 business days. Want matching sisters or a birthday name on the band? Message me before ordering.

13 TAGS

pillowcase dress

toddler dress

girls dress

summer dress

girls sundress

birthday outfit

cotton dress

handmade dress

kids clothing

sister dresses

custom kids dress

twirl dress

toddler sundress

#5 • Scrunchie 5-Pack

\$15

Materials ≈ \$2

⌚ 25 min (5 pcs)

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 3, 10, 11

ETSY TITLE

Cotton Scrunchie Set of 5, Handmade Hair Scrunchies, Linen Scrunchie Pack, Gentle Hair Ties, Stocking Stuffer for Teens

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Scrunchies — Set of 5 — Cotton & Linen

DESCRIPTION

Five handmade scrunchies that hold without pulling or creasing your hair.

- Fabric tube 20 × 3.5 in / 50 × 9 cm, strong 1/4 in / 6 mm elastic
- Mixed cotton and linen in one color family (pick: neutrals, florals, brights)
- Machine wash in a laundry bag

Ready to ship in 1–2 business days. Great as party favors — ask me for 10+ sets.

13 TAGS

scrunchies scrunchie set hair scrunchie cotton scrunchie linen scrunchie stocking stuffer gift for teen
hair accessories party favors hair tie set gift under 20 handmade scrunchie vsco scrunchie

#6 • Over-Collar Pet Bandana

\$14

Materials ≈ \$1.80

⌚ 15 min

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 3, 9, 11

ETSY TITLE

Dog Bandana Over the Collar, Slide On Pet Scarf, Cotton Dog Bandana, Sizes XS to XL, Puppy Gift, Cat Bandana, Seasonal

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Over-the-Collar Dog Bandana — XS to XL

DESCRIPTION

Slides onto your pet's own collar: no ties, no knots, nothing to choke on.

- Sizes by collar width: XS/S up to 3/4 in / 2 cm, M/L up to 1 in / 2.5 cm, XL up to 1.5 in / 4 cm
- Double-layer cotton, reversible (two prints)
- Machine wash cold

Seasonal prints for birthdays, holidays and gotcha days. Ready to ship in 1–2 days.

13 TAGS

dog bandana pet bandana over collar bandana puppy gift cat bandana dog scarf dog accessories
dog birthday reversible bandana pet gift dog lover gift slide on bandana dog clothes

#7 • Reusable Produce Bags, Set of 3

\$18

Materials ≈ \$3.50

⌚ 30 min (set)

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 8, 10, 12

ETSY TITLE

Reusable Produce Bags Set of 3, Drawstring Mesh and Cotton Bags, Zero Waste Grocery Bags, Eco Friendly Kitchen Gift

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Reusable Drawstring Produce Bags — Set of 3 (S/M/L)

DESCRIPTION

Three drawstring bags for fruit, veg, bulk bins and bread.

- Sizes: S 8 × 10 in / 20 × 25 cm · M 10 × 12 in / 25 × 30 cm · L 12 × 15 in / 30 × 38 cm
- Lightweight cotton voile or muslin, French seams (nothing to fray), cotton drawstring with stopper
- Wash, dry, reuse for years

Ready to ship in 1–2 business days.

13 TAGS

produce bags

reusable bags

zero waste

drawstring bag

eco friendly gift

grocery bags

muslin bags

bulk bin bags

sustainable gift

bread bag

kitchen gift

plastic free

farmers market

#8 • Quilted Pot Holders, Set of 2

\$16

Materials ≈ \$3

⌚ 30 min (set)

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 6, 7, 8

ETSY TITLE

Quilted Pot Holders Set of 2, Cotton Hot Pads, Insulated Trivets, Farmhouse Kitchen Decor, Hostess Gift, Housewarming

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Quilted Pot Holders — Set of 2

DESCRIPTION

Two thick quilted pot holders that actually protect your hands.

- Size: 8 × 8 in / 20 × 20 cm with hanging loop
- 100% cotton outer, one layer of heat-resistant (insulated) batting + one layer of cotton batting
- Quilted in a 1 in / 2.5 cm grid, bias-bound edges

Machine wash cold, tumble dry low. Ready to ship in 1–2 business days.

13 TAGS

pot holders

hot pads

quilted potholder

kitchen decor

hostess gift

housewarming gift

trivet

farmhouse kitchen

cotton pot holder

gift for cook

kitchen linens

mothers day gift

handmade kitchen

#9 • Cloth Napkins, Set of 4

\$28

Materials ≈ \$6

⌚ 40 min (set)

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 6, 8, 10, 11

ETSY TITLE

Linen Cloth Napkins Set of 4, Mitered Corner Dinner Napkins, Reusable Table Napkins, Thanksgiving Table, Wedding Gift

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Linen Cloth Napkins — Set of 4, Mitered Corners

DESCRIPTION

Everyday cloth napkins with a proper finish.

- Size: 18 × 18 in / 45 × 45 cm finished
- Linen-cotton blend, mitered corners, 1/2 in / 1.3 cm double-fold hem
- Pre-washed: no surprise shrinking

Choose from 6 colors. Sets of 6, 8 or 12 on request. Ready to ship in 1–2 business days.

13 TAGS

cloth napkins linen napkins dinner napkins table linens reusable napkins wedding gift thanksgiving table
mitered napkins napkin set hostess gift holiday table eco napkins farmhouse table

#10 • Boxy Toiletry Bag

\$28

Materials ≈ \$5.50

⌚ 50 min

Etsy + Marketplace

Photos: Shots 1, 2, 4, 5, 12

ETSY TITLE

Boxy Toiletry Bag, Large Makeup Bag with Handle, Waterproof Lined Dopp Kit, Travel Wash Bag, Gift for Him or Her

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Handmade Boxy Toiletry Bag — Waterproof Lining

DESCRIPTION

A wide-opening toiletry bag that stands up on the bathroom counter.

- Size: 10 × 6 × 6 in / 25 × 15 × 15 cm
- Canvas or quilting cotton outer, wipe-clean waterproof lining (PUL)
- 14 in / 35 cm zipper that opens wide, side carry handle

Spot clean or machine wash cold. Ready to ship in 1–2 business days.

13 TAGS

toiletry bag dopp kit makeup bag travel bag wash bag boxy pouch gift for him gift for her
waterproof pouch cosmetic bag travel organizer groomsmen gift large makeup bag

#11 • Made-to-Measure Elastic-Waist Linen Skirt

\$95

Materials ≈ \$22

⌚ 2.5 h

Etsy (made to order) + local

Photos: Shots 7, 9, 12, 14

ETSY TITLE

Custom Linen Skirt Made to Measure, Elastic Waist Midi Skirt with Pockets, Any Length, Womens Linen Clothing, Plus Size

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Custom Linen Midi Skirt — Made to Your Measurements

DESCRIPTION

A linen midi skirt sewn to your waist, hip and length — no more “fits the hips but not the waist”.

- Sizes XS–5XL (US 0–30), cut to your measurements: send waist, hips and desired length after ordering
- 1.25 in / 3 cm covered elastic waistband, two in-seam pockets
- Midweight washed linen, 8 colors

Made to order in 7–10 business days. Free adjustment of the length within 14 days of delivery.

13 TAGS

linen skirt

midi skirt

custom skirt

elastic waist skirt

skirt with pockets

plus size skirt

made to measure

womens linen

summer skirt

custom clothing

linen clothing

maxi skirt

a line skirt

#12 • Alterations & Hemming (local service)

from \$15

Materials ≈ thread

 see menu

Marketplace / local groups / Nextdoor (not Etsy)

Photos: Shots 13 (before/after) + a photo of the printed menu

ETSY TITLE

(Not for Etsy: Etsy is for items, not local services. Use this text in Facebook groups, Nextdoor and Marketplace-style posts.)

MARKETPLACE TITLE

Clothing Alterations & Hems — 5-Day Turnaround — [Your Neighborhood]

DESCRIPTION

Pants too long? Dress too big? I hem, take in and repair clothes from my home studio in [your neighborhood].

- Pants hem from \$15 · jeans (original hem kept) from \$22 · take in a dress from \$30 · zippers from \$20
- Drop-off: Tuesday 5–7 pm and Saturday 9–11 am · ready in 5 days · 48 h rush +50%
- Pinned on you at drop-off, so it fits the first time

Message me what you need and I'll give you a price range right away.

13 TAGS

alterations

hemming

tailor near me

seamstress

pants hem

jeans hem

dress alterations

zipper repair

clothing repair

prom alterations

bridesmaid hem

uniform hems

local tailor

The 40 keywords buyers actually search

Use them in this order: the first 2–3 words of your title, then tags, then the first line of the description. One keyword per slot — repeating the same word in title and tags doesn't add anything.

GIFTS (USE IN EVERY TITLE)

- 1. gift for her
- 2. gift for mom
- 3. teacher gift
- 4. housewarming gift
- 5. hostess gift
- 6. bridesmaid gift
- 7. stocking stuffer
- 8. gift under 20

BAGS & POUCHES

- 9. zipper pouch
- 10. makeup bag
- 11. pencil case
- 12. canvas tote bag
- 13. market bag
- 14. toiletry bag
- 15. travel organizer
- 16. library bag

KITCHEN & HOME

- 17. linen apron
- 18. cloth napkins
- 19. pot holders
- 20. produce bags
- 21. table linens
- 22. farmhouse kitchen
- 23. zero waste

KIDS

- 24. toddler dress
- 25. pillowcase dress
- 26. girls dress
- 27. birthday outfit
- 28. sister dresses
- 29. kids clothing

PETS

- 30. dog bandana
- 31. pet bandana
- 32. puppy gift

CUSTOM & CLOTHING

- 33. custom skirt
- 34. made to measure
- 35. linen skirt
- 36. plus size skirt

LOCAL SERVICE SEARCHES (GROUPS, NEXTDOOR, GOOGLE)

- 37. alterations near me
- 38. seamstress
- 39. pants hem
- 40. prom dress alterations

HOW TO FIND YOUR OWN NEXT 40

1. Type your product in the Etsy search bar and write down the suggestions that drop down — those are real searches.
2. Open the top 5 results: copy the words that repeat in their titles.
3. Add a person (mom, teacher, bridesmaid), an occasion (birthday, Mother's Day, back to school) or a style (farmhouse, boho, minimalist).
4. Every 30 days: Etsy Stats → "How shoppers found you" → keep the words that bring visits, replace the rest.

PART 4

The Phone Photo Studio

15 shots that make a homemade piece look boutique — with a window, two foam boards and the phone you already have. Total cost: about \$8.

Set up once (20 minutes)

ELEMENT	HOW
Light	One window with indirect daylight (north-facing or any window without direct sun). Shoot between 10 am and 3 pm. Turn OFF every lamp in the room: mixed light turns white fabric yellow.
Background	2 white foam boards 20 × 30 in / 50 × 75 cm (about \$4 each at a craft or dollar store). One flat on the table as the floor, one standing behind as the wall, or as a reflector opposite the window.
Props	A wooden hanger, a plain white mug, a small plant or eucalyptus stem, a measuring tape, kraft tissue paper. Nothing with logos or text.
Phone settings	Clean the lens with a soft cloth. Main camera at 1× (never the ultra-wide 0.5×). Grid on. Tap on the fabric to focus, then slide the exposure down one notch so whites don't burn out. No flash, no filters, no portrait mode for flat-lays.
Edit (2 minutes max)	In the phone's own editor: brightness +10, shadows +15, warmth -5 if the whites look yellow. Crop square (Etsy thumbnails are square-ish) and keep the item filling ~80% of the frame.

WHICH SHOTS FOR WHICH LISTING

Products: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 12, 15 (8 photos minimum). Clothing: 1, 7, 9, 12 + a back view. Alterations posts: 13 always, 14 for videos. Sets: 10. Shops with colors: 11.

The 15-shot list

#	SHOT	SETUP	PHONE SETTINGS	WHY IT SELLS
1	Hero flat-lay	Item centered on the white floor board, window on your left. Stand on a step stool and shoot straight down.	1×, grid on, phone parallel to the table (use the level cross in the camera).	Your thumbnail. It must read clearly at the size of a stamp.
2	45° standing shot	Item standing up (stuff bags with tissue), white wall board behind. Phone at table height, angled 45°.	1×, tap to focus on the front edge.	Shows shape and volume that a flat-lay hides.
3	Scale in hand	Hold the item in one hand against the white wall, clean nails, no rings.	1×, focus on the item, not the hand.	Answers “how big is it really?” without reading the listing.
4	Inside / lining	Open zipper or top, fold one side back, lining visible. Light from the side so the inside isn't dark.	Exposure +1 notch if the inside is dark.	Lining is where handmade beats cheap. Show it.
5	Closure close-up	Zipper pull, button or snap filling the frame. 15 cm / 6 in from the lens.	Tap to focus; if blurry, move back and crop later.	Buyers look at closures to judge quality.
6	Seam & topstitch macro	A straight line of topstitching or a bound edge, in raking light (window at 90°).	Lock focus by pressing and holding on the stitches.	Proof of craftsmanship: straight, even stitches.
7	Fabric texture	Fill the whole frame with the fabric, slightly folded so light catches the weave.	1×, 20 cm / 8 in away.	Linen, canvas and cotton sell by feel. Texture is feel in a photo.
8	Styled lifestyle	Item in its real place: tote on a chair back, apron on a hook in the kitchen, napkins on a set table.	Keep the background uncluttered; turn off lamps.	Lets the buyer picture it in her own home.
9	Worn on body (headless)	Friend or you wearing it, from shoulders to knees, against a plain wall, window in front of the person.	Phone at waist height, 1×, 1.5–2 m / 5–6 ft away.	The #1 shot for clothing and bags. Face optional.
10	Set / bundle flat-lay	All pieces of a set arranged in a grid or fan on the floor board, equal gaps.	Straight down, like shot 1.	Sells the higher-priced set, not just one piece.
11	Color / print options lineup	One of each color in a row, same folding, same spacing. Label with small paper numbers.	Straight down or 45°.	Turns “does it come in blue?” into a quick choice.
12	Measurement shot	Measuring tape laid along the item with inches AND cm visible (or two photos).	Focus on the tape numbers.	Cuts “what size is it?” questions by half.
13	Before / after (alterations)	Same garment, same hanger, same spot, same phone position — before pinning and after the job. Mark the phone position with tape on the floor.	Identical framing; don't zoom.	Your best alterations ad. One good pair beats ten words.
14	Process clip (3 seconds)	Hands at the machine or cutting fabric. Phone on a stack of books or a cheap tripod, side view.	Video mode, 1×, lock exposure (press and hold).	5 clips × 3 s = a 15-second video for Reels or TikTok.

#	SHOT	SETUP	PHONE SETTINGS	WHY IT SELLS
15	Packaging shot	Item wrapped in kraft tissue with a thank-you card and a twine bow, on the white board.	45°, soft light.	Shows it arrives like a gift. Great for the last photo of every listing.

5 MISTAKES THAT MAKE HANDMADE LOOK CHEAP

1. Yellow light from a lamp mixed with daylight → turn lamps off.
2. Wrinkles → press everything, even the tote you "just" finished.
3. Busy background (couch, bedspread, clutter) → white boards or one plain surface.
4. Ultra-wide lens (0.5×) → distorts shape; always 1× and step back.
5. Loose threads visible in the macro shot → clip, lint-roll, re-shoot.

50 Copy-Paste DM & Comment Scripts

Words that turn "so pretty!" into "how much?" and "how much?" into a drop-off.
Replace everything in [brackets]. Read them out loud once and change any word that doesn't sound like you.

THE 3 RULES BEHIND EVERY SCRIPT

1. **Reply within 2 hours** during the day. Speed wins more jobs than price.
2. **Public = range, private = exact.** Never negotiate in the comments.
3. **End with a choice** ("Tuesday or Saturday?"), not with "let me know".

Inquiries & launch

1 LAUNCH POST · YOUR PERSONAL FACEBOOK

Some news 📣 I'm now taking **hems and clothing alterations** from home. Pants hems from \$15, jeans with the original hem kept from \$22, dresses taken in from \$30. Drop-off Tuesday evenings and Saturday mornings, ready in 5 days. If you've got a pile of "I'll get that fixed someday" clothes, send me a message 😊
[before/after photo + menu photo]

Price anchors in the first post filter out people looking for free favors.

2 PRIVATE MESSAGE · YOUR 15 CLOSEST CONTACTS

Hi [name]! Quick one: I've started doing alterations and small sewing jobs from home. If you or [partner/kids] have anything that needs a hem or a fix, I'd love to be your first client — I'll do your first job at 20% off as a thank-you. No pressure at all!

One by one, never as a group message. Personal = replies.

3 GROUP POST · LOCAL COMMUNITY GROUP

Hi neighbors 🙌 I'm [first name], I live near [landmark] and I sew. I just started doing hems, take-ins, zippers and repairs from my home studio with a 5-day turnaround. Here's a pair of jeans I hemmed this week keeping the original hem [photo]. Happy to answer questions in the comments!

Show and tell, not an ad. Read group rules first.

4 COMMENT: "HOW MUCH FOR A HEM?"

Hi [name]! Pants hems are \$15–20 depending on the fabric, jeans \$18–25 (or \$22–30 if you want to keep the original hem). I'll message you so we can find a drop-off time 😊

Always a range in public, exact price in private.

5 DM: "CAN YOU FIX THIS?" + PHOTO

Thanks for the photo! Yes, I can do that. It's a [service] — usually \$[X–Y]. I'll give you the exact price when I see it at drop-off. My next openings are [Tuesday 5–7 pm] or [Saturday 9–11 am]. Which works better?

End every answer with a choice between two times.

6 COMMENT: "SO PRETTY!" / ❤️ ON A PRODUCT POST

Thank you so much, [name]! 🥰 This one's a lined zipper pouch — I have it in 3 prints right now. Would you like me to send you the photos?

Turn a compliment into a yes/no question you can DM.

7 DM: "DO YOU SHIP?"

I do! Shipping in the US is \$[5] for small items (1–2 business days to send). Or free local pickup [area] on [days]. Which one do you prefer?

8 DM: "WHAT'S THE TURNAROUND?"

Standard is 5 days from drop-off. If you need it sooner, I have a 48-hour rush option for +50%. When do you need it by?

Asking the deadline often uncovers an event = a bigger job.

9 DM: "DO YOU DO [SOMETHING NOT ON YOUR MENU]?"

Good question! I don't offer [service] yet, so I'd rather not practice on your favorite piece. What I can do is [closest service you offer]. Would that help?

Saying no to what you can't do yet builds more trust than a bad job.

10 DM: SOMEONE ASKS FOR YOUR "MENU"

Here's my current price list 📌 [photo of printed menu]. Prices are ranges; I confirm the exact price when I see the garment. Anything catch your eye?

Price objections

11 "THAT'S EXPENSIVE FOR A HEM"

I get it! A hem is about 25–30 minutes of work: measuring on you, pinning, cutting, finishing the edge and pressing so it looks like it came from the store. It's \$15 to make pants you already paid for wearable again — and if it's not right, I adjust it free within 7 days.

Explain the work, never apologize for the price.

12 "THE DRY CLEANER CHARGES LESS"

That's fair — some do! The difference with me: I pin it on you, so it fits the first time, and it's ready in 5 days. If price is the main thing for this one, go for it, and I'm here if you need something trickier later 😊

Let her go gracefully; she often comes back.

13 **"CAN YOU DO IT CHEAPER?"**

My prices are the same for everyone, but here's what I can do: if you bring 3 items at once, basic hems are \$15 each instead of \$18–20. Want me to save a Saturday slot?

Never discount; bundle.

14 **"I'LL THINK ABOUT IT"**

Of course! Just so you know, my Saturday slots fill up first. I'll hold one for you until Thursday — just reply "yes" if you want it.

A soft deadline, not pressure.

15 **"I CAN BUY A NEW ONE FOR THAT PRICE" (PRODUCTS)**

True, you'll find cheaper ones in big stores! Mine is lined, interfaced so it holds its shape, and every seam is finished inside — it's made to last years, not months. And it's made one at a time, by me.

16 **"WHY IS CUSTOM SO MUCH MORE?"**

A custom piece is cut to your measurements and sewn start to finish just for you — about [2.5] hours plus fabric. Ready-to-wear is made in thousands in one size. You're paying for the fit you can't buy off the rack.

17 **"MY FRIEND SEWS, SHE'D DO IT FOR FREE"**

That's lovely! If she's busy or it's a trickier job (zippers, lined dresses, bridal), I'm happy to help. Here's my menu so you have it 😊

18 **"CAN I PAY AFTER I SEE IT?"**

For alterations, yes: you pay at pickup. For custom pieces I take a 50% deposit to buy the fabric, and the rest when it's ready. That way the fabric is chosen for you and nobody loses out.

19 **"DO YOU GIVE A DISCOUNT FOR FAMILY / FRIENDS?"**

You get something better than a discount: first spot in my schedule 😊 And my 3-for-\$50 hem bundle is open to everyone.

20 **"THE PRICE WENT UP SINCE LAST TIME"**

It did — my prices went up on [date] for new drop-offs. You're still getting the same care and the same free 7-day adjustment. Thanks for sticking with me! 💛

Custom orders

21 **"CAN YOU MAKE ME A [SKIRT/DRESS]?"**

Yes, I'd love to! To give you a price I need 3 things: (1) a photo or link of the style you like, (2) your measurements — waist, hips and length, I can take them for you, (3) when you need it. Custom skirts start at \$95 including linen or cotton.

Three questions qualify the order in one message.

22 SENDING THE QUOTE

Here's your quote: [garment] in [fabric], made to your measurements, with [pockets/lining] — \$[price]. Timeline: [7–10] business days from deposit. 50% deposit (\$[X]) to start; I buy the fabric the same day. Want me to reserve your spot?

23 ASKING FOR THE DEPOSIT

Wonderful! Your spot is reserved for 48 hours. You can pay the deposit of \$[X] by [payment method you accept]. As soon as it's in, I'll send you a photo of your fabric 😊

24 FABRIC CONFIRMATION PHOTO

Your fabric is here! [photo] This is the [color/print] linen for your skirt. Does it look the way you imagined? If yes, I'll cut on [day].

A 10-second photo prevents 90% of "this isn't what I wanted".

25 FITTING REMINDER

Hi [name]! Reminder: your fitting is [day] at [time]. Please wear or bring the shoes you'll wear with it — it changes the hem length. It takes about 15 minutes.

26 READY FOR PICKUP

It's ready! 🎉 [photo] Your [garment] is pressed and waiting for you. Pickup [day/time window]. Remaining balance: \$[X].

27 RUSH REQUEST ON A CUSTOM

I can do it by [date] with my rush option (+50%), which means it jumps ahead of other orders. Total would be \$[X]. Want to go ahead?

28 CLIENT WANTS CHANGES MID-WAY

Totally doable! Adding [change] is +\$[X] and adds [1–2] days. Should I include it?

Every change has a price and a time. Say both.

29 BULK / GROUP REQUEST (BRIDESMAIDS, TEAM, SCHOOL)

I'd love to help! For [number] pieces I'd do \$[price] each (normally \$[higher]). I'd need all measurements by [date] and a 50% deposit to order fabric in one batch. Want me to send a form everyone can fill?

30 TURNING DOWN A CUSTOM ORDER POLITELY

Thank you for thinking of me! This one is outside what I offer right now ([reason: heavy leather / tailored suit / 3-day deadline]), and I want you to have a piece you love. I hope you'll come back for [what you do offer]!

Follow-ups

31 ASKED THE PRICE, NEVER BOOKED (AFTER 3 DAYS)

Hi [name]! Just checking in about your [pants/dress]. I have a free slot this [Saturday 9–11 am] if you'd like to drop it off. No worries if the timing's not right!

Maximum 2 follow-ups per person.

32 SECOND AND LAST FOLLOW-UP (AFTER 7 DAYS)

Hi [name], last nudge from me 😊 My schedule fills up before [event/season], so if you'd like the [job] done before then, reply and I'll save you a spot.

33 LIKED A PRODUCT, DIDN'T BUY

Hi [name]! You liked the [item] the other day — I have one left in [color]. Want me to hold it for you until Friday?

34 PICKUP REMINDER

Hi [name]! Your [garment] is ready and waiting. Pickup windows: Tuesday 5–7 pm or Saturday 9–11 am. See you soon!

35 ITEM NOT PICKED UP AFTER 14 DAYS

Hi [name], friendly reminder that your [garment] is ready. I keep finished items for 30 days — after that they're donated. Can you pick it up this week?

Put the 30-day rule in writing at drop-off too.

36 AFTER A SALE ON MARKETPLACE

Thanks again for buying the [item]! 😊 If you ever need hems or small alterations, I do those too — here's my menu.

Every product buyer is a future alterations client.

37 SEASONAL NUDGE TO PAST CLIENTS

Hi [name]! [Prom / wedding / back-to-school] season is coming and my calendar is filling up. If you have anything that needs fitting before [date], let me know this week 😊

38 CHECKING FIT AFTER PICKUP (DAY 3)

Hi [name]! How are the [pants] working out? If anything feels off, I adjust it free within 7 days.

This one message creates reviews.

39 CLIENT WENT QUIET AFTER A CUSTOM QUOTE

Hi [name]! Just checking if you had any questions about the [garment] quote. The fabric price is good until [date] — after that I'd need to re-check it.

40 RE-ENGAGING AN OLD CONTACT

Hi [name]! It's been a while — I've added [new service, e.g. zipper replacements] to my menu. If anything in your closet needs a little love, I'm here 😊

Reviews, referrals & partners

41 IN PERSON · PITCHING A BUSINESS FOR OVERFLOW

Hi, I'm [name], I do alterations from my home studio nearby. I noticed you [send out / don't offer] alterations. I'd love to be the person you send those jobs to: 5-day turnaround, pinned carefully, and I give you 10% of every job you send. Can I leave you a few menus and a sample of my work?

Bring the printed menu and one finished hem you can show.

42 PARTNER FOLLOW-UP (1 WEEK LATER)

Hi! It's [name], the seamstress who stopped by last week. Just checking if any customers asked about alterations — I have openings this week and I'm happy to pick up from your shop on [day].

43 THANKING A PARTNER

Thank you for sending [client] my way! Here's your 10% (\$[X]) for the [job]. I really appreciate it ❤️

Pay referral fees fast. It's what keeps them sending.

44 ASKING A HAPPY CLIENT FOR A PHOTO

I'm so glad you love it! Would you mind if I shared a photo of the [garment] (no face) on my page? It really helps a small business like mine.

45 DELIVERING WITH A REQUEST

Here's your [item] 🧡 If you're happy with it, the biggest help is telling one friend who needs a hem or a fix.

46 REVIEW REQUEST · LOCAL CLIENTS

Hi [name]! Thank you again for trusting me with your [garment]. Would you leave me a short review? It takes 1 minute and helps neighbors find me: [where to review — Google Business Profile, local group post]. Thank you!!

Ask within 3 days of pickup, while she's happy.

47 REVIEW REQUEST · ETSY BUYERS

Hi [name]! Your [item] should have arrived — I hope you love it! If you have a minute, a review on Etsy means the world to my small shop. And if anything isn't perfect, message me first and I'll make it right.

48 THANKING FOR A REVIEW

Thank you so much for the kind words, [name]! It made my week 🥰 See you next time you need a hem!

Reply publicly to every review.

49 ASKING FOR REFERRALS

I'm so glad you're happy! Here's a little card for you: for every friend who books a job with me, you get \$5 off your next one — and she gets \$5 off her first. No limit 😊

Hand a referral card with every pickup.

50

REPLYING TO A NEGATIVE REVIEW (PUBLIC)

Hi [name], I'm sorry the [job] didn't meet your expectations. I'd like to make it right — I've sent you a message so we can fix it free of charge this week.

Short, calm, public; solve it in private. Never argue.

Day 30 is a starting line.

By now you have a price list you trust, clients who come back, listings that bring strangers and a routine you can run in a few hours a week.

Month 2: same routine, one new service, one new product. Target \$1,500.

Sew it. Price it. Sell it.